DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH &. HUMAN SERVICES

Public Health Service

Indian Health Service
Phoenix Indian Medical Center
4212 North 16th Street
Phoenix, Arizona 85016

Memorandum

To: Executive Leadership, Phoenix Indian Medical Center
From: Kevin D. Turnage, Policy Officer
Date: June 9, 2025

Subject: Implementation of Revised Policy Review Cycle per IHM Transmittal Notice 24-16

I. Purpose

This memorandum provides formal notice of a required change in the directive review cycle pursuant to **Transmittal Notice 24-16**, dated October 24, 2024, signed by IHS Director Roselyn Tso. This change impacts all policy and procedure review timelines across IHS facilities, including PIMC.

II. Directive Change Summary

Effective immediately, the Indian Health Manual (IHM) has been amended to shorten the required review interval for all directives from three years to two years:

"Directives must be reviewed at least every 2 years by the originating office. Directives that are not reviewed within 2 years shall be considered non-compliant and subject to revision or rescission."
— IHM Part 1, Chapter 1, § 1-1.2K(4), amended via TN 24-16

This policy governs all IHS-issued and facility-level directives, including clinical, administrative, and operational policies stored in **PolicyStat**.

III. Compliance and Facility Impact

This revision requires that PIMC:

- Review and revise any directive last updated more than **24 months** ago;
- Label all overdue policies as **non-compliant** until formally reviewed and approved;
- Update its directive management and tracking procedures to reflect the new biennial standard;
- Mitigate risks related to **accreditation readiness**, **CMS Conditions of Participation**, and **OMB Circular A–123** compliance.

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IV. Implementation Plan

As Policy Officer, I will begin the process of implementing this change in **PolicyStat**, the facility's policy management platform, on:

June 11, 2025

This process will include:

- Identifying all active policies exceeding the two-year threshold;
- Initiating review workflows with originating departments;
- Updating review schedules, policy metadata, and internal reporting tools;
- Coordinating with compliance and leadership staff to ensure facility-wide adherence.

V. Conclusion

This action aligns PIMC with federal IHS directive policy and strengthens our facility's internal control and accreditation posture. Further updates or action items will be communicated as implementation progresses.

Please direct any questions or requests for prioritization to my office prior to the June 11 implementation date.

Respectfully,

Digitally signed by Kevin D. Turnage -S
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Kevin D. Turnage
Policy Officer
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